Post-deployment tasks

HCI

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Post-deployment tasks

Post-deployment tasks overview

After you deploy Rancher on NetApp HCI, you should continue with post-deployment activities.

- Ensure Rancher Support parity
- Improve Rancher VM resiliency
- Configure monitoring
- Install Trident
- Enable Trident support for user clusters

Find more information

- Rancher documentation about architecture
- Kubernetes terminology for Rancher
- NetApp Element Plug-in for vCenter Server
- NetApp HCI Resources page

Ensure Rancher Support parity

After you deploy Rancher on NetApp HCI, you need to ensure that the number of Rancher Support cores you purchased matches the number of CPU cores you are using for Rancher management VMs and user clusters.

If you purchased Rancher Support for only part of your NetApp HCI compute resources, you need to take action in VMware vSphere to ensure that Rancher on NetApp HCI and its managed user clusters are only running on hosts for which you have purchased Rancher Support. See the VMware vSphere documentation for information about how to help ensure this by confining compute workloads to specific hosts.

Find more information

- vSphere HA and DRS Affinity Rules
- Create VM Anti-Affinity Rules
- Rancher documentation about architecture
- Kubernetes terminology for Rancher
- NetApp Element Plug-in for vCenter Server
- NetApp HCI Resources page

Improve Rancher VM resiliency

After you deploy Rancher on NetApp HCI, your vSphere environment will contain three new nodes as virtual machines to host the Rancher environment. The Rancher web UI is

available from each of these nodes. For full resiliency, each of the three virtual machines along with the corresponding virtual disks should reside on a different physical host after events like power cycles and failovers.

To ensure that each VM and its resources remain on a different physical host, you can create VMware vSphere Distributed Resource Scheduler (DRS) anti-affinity rules. This is not automated as part of Rancher on NetApp HCI deployment.

For instructions on how to configure DRS anti-affinity rules, see the following VMware documentation resources:

Create VM Anti-Affinity Rules

vSphere HA and DRS Affinity Rules

Find more information

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Enable monitoring

After you deploy Rancher on NetApp HCI, You can enable Active IQ storage monitoring (for SolidFire all-flash storage and NetApp HCI) and NetApp HCI compute monitoring (for NetApp HCI only) if you did not already do so during installation or upgrade.

For instructions on how to enable monitoring, see Enable Active IQ and NetApp HCI monitoring.

Find more information

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Install Trident

Learn about how to install Trident after you install Rancher on NetApp HCI. Trident is a storage orchestrator, which integrates with Docker and Kubernetes, as well as platforms built on these technologies, such as Red Hat OpenShift, Rancher, and IBM Cloud Private. The goal of Trident is to make the provisioning, connection, and consumption of storage transparent and frictionless for the applications. Trident is a fully supported open source project maintained by NetApp. Trident enables you to create, manage, and interact with persistent storage volumes in the standard Kubernetes format that you are familiar with.

For more information about Trident, see the Trident documentation.

What you'll need

- You have installed Rancher on NetApp HCI.
- You have deployed your user clusters.
- You have configured your user cluster networks for Trident. See Enable Trident support for user clusters for instructions.
- You have completed the necessary prerequisite steps for work node preparation for Trident. See the Trident documentation.

About this task

The Trident installer catalog is installed as part of the Rancher installation using NetApp Hybrid Cloud Control. In this task, you use the installer catalog to install and configure Trident.
As part of the Rancher installation, NetApp provides a node template. If you are not planning to use the node template that NetApp provides, and you want to provision on RHEL or CentOS, there might be additional requirements. If you change your worker node to RHEL or CentOS, there are several prerequisites that should be met. See the Trident documentation.

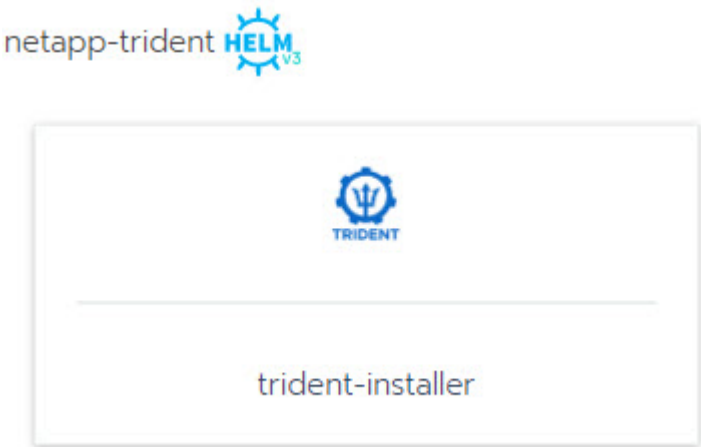
Steps

1. From the Rancher UI, select a project for your user cluster.

   For information about projects and namespaces, see the Rancher documentation.

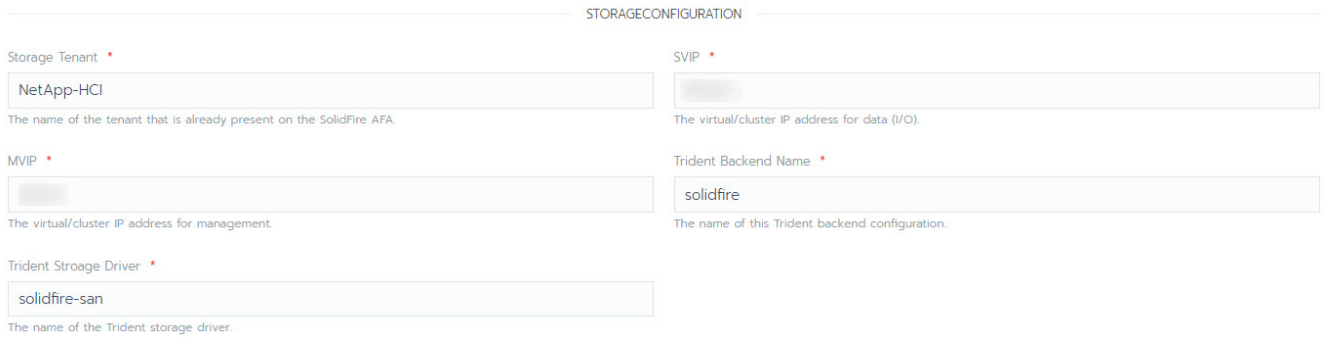
2. Select **Apps**, and select **Launch**.

3. On the **Catalog** page, select the Trident installer.



   On the page that opens, you can select the **Detailed Descriptions** arrow to learn more about the Trident app and also to find the link to the Trident documentation.

4. Select the **Configurations Options** arrow, and enter the credentials and storage configuration information.

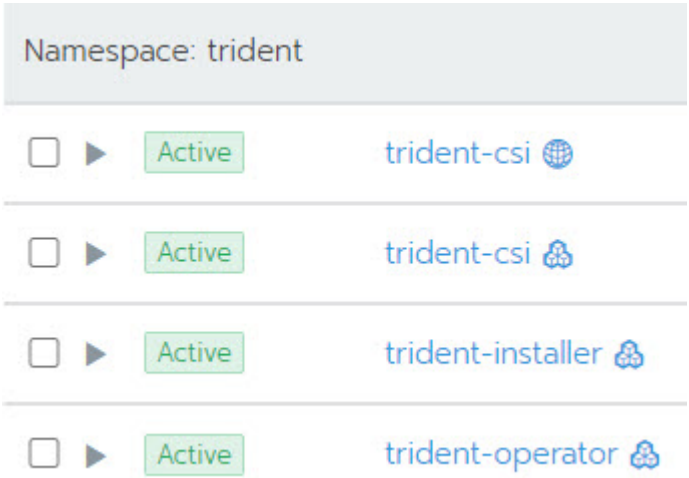


> The default storage tenant is NetApp HCI. You can change this value. You can also change the backend name. However, do not change the default storage driver value, which is **solidfire-san**.

5. Select **Launch**.

   This installs the Trident workload on the **trident** namespace.

6. Select **Resources > Workloads**, and verify that the **trident** namespace includes the following components:



7. (Optional) Select **Storage** for the user cluster to see the storage classes that you can use for your persistent volumes.

> The three storage classes are **solidfire-gold**, **solidfire-silver**, and **solidfire-bronze**. You can make one of these storage classes the default by selecting the icon under the **Default** column.

Find more information

- Enable Trident support for user clusters
- Rancher documentation about architecture
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Enable Trident support for user clusters

If your NetApp HCI environment does not have a route between the management and storage networks, and you deploy user clusters that need Trident support, you need to further configure your user cluster networks after installing Trident. For each user cluster, you need to enable communication between the management and storage networks. You can do this by modifying the networking configuration for each node in the user cluster.

About this task

Follow these general steps to modify the networking configuration for each node in the user cluster. These steps assume that you created the user cluster with the default node template that is installed with Rancher on NetApp HCI.

> You can make these changes as part of a custom node template to use for future user clusters.

Steps

1. Deploy a user cluster with existing default template.
2. Connect the storage network to the user cluster.
   a. Open the VMware vSphere web client for the connected vCenter instance.
   b. In the Hosts and Clusters inventory tree, select a node in the newly deployed user cluster.
   c. Edit the node's settings.
   d. In the settings dialog, add a new network adapter.
   e. In the **New Network** drop down list, browse for a network and select **HCI_Internal_Storage_Data_Network**.
   f. Expand the network adapter section and record the MAC address for the new network adapter.
   g. Click **OK**.
3. In Rancher, download the SSH private key file for each node in the user cluster.
4. Connect using SSH to a node in the user cluster, using the private key file that you have downloaded for that node:

   ```
   ssh -i <private key filename> <ip address>
   ```

5. As the superuser, edit and save the `/etc/netplan/50-cloud-init.yaml` file so that it includes the `ens224` section, similar to the following example. Replace `<MAC address>` with the MAC address you recorded earlier:

```
network:
    ethernets:
        ens192:
            dhcp4: true
            match:
                macaddress: 00:50:56:91:1d:41
            set-name: ens192
        ens224:
            dhcp4: true
            match:
                macaddress: <MAC address>
            set-name: ens224
    version: 2
```

6. Use the following command to reconfigure the network:

```
`netplan try`
```

7. Repeat steps 4 through 6 for each remaining node in the user cluster.
8. When you have reconfigured the network for each node in the user cluster, you can deploy applications in the user cluster that utilize Trident.

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